

Ever since video games have been around, people have done everything they can, to get better at them. Many people have put hours, even days, or months, into a game, just to get better at a single game that has taken over their lives on such a level, where they choose to forsake any human interaction, except for the interaction with in game enemies, or teammates, when it comes to online multiplayer games.

Although, not all of us gamers are on the honest to Gaben side of things. Many of us, from the gaming community, decide to switch to the dark side, just to get better at a game. Or at least, look

RISE OF THE HACKER NATION

Ever since computers started getting more secure, people have been trying to look for ways to bypass the various security measures introduced by developers. There is no definite date to when hacking really began, but it's safe to assume that the day computers were invented, people started thinking of ways to take them over.

Hacking in videogames, as well, has no definite timeline. Nobody knows exactly when it started, but it boomed around the '90s, with multiplayer games coming around. People who couldn't get better at a game through practice, went onto the internet, and bought a few hacks from a not-so-legal source, booted up the game, and they were suddenly playing better than professionals, who had been playing the game since it came out.

Hackers haven't just stopped there. Many times, people have been scammed out of their Steam money, or all of their money on their Steam account had been used to buy pointless stuff, and all the goods bought with money were sent to a different account, and from that account, to another, and so on, so that the original recipient could never be traced down.

CRACKDOWN

Once this problem started growing from a few isolated incidents, to a full blown epidemic, developers started stepping in. Obviously, nobody who logs into their game wants their experience, and time to be ruined by some person who has no skill, and is winning solely on the basis of hacks. People started getting ticked off, and complaints about rampant hacking started flooding in, and that's when devel-



better. People resort to downloading a few hacks from the shady part of the internet, and boot into a game, run their hacks, and ruin the game for their teammates, as well as their opponents, for the amount of time they're in the game, just to make themselves look better, and rank themselves, or their friends up.

The weird thing is, people who buy these hacks don't realise that the people who make these hacks are actual hackers, who make hacks for a living, and that the hacks are not only limited to innocent videogame hacks and mods. These hackers are also in the business of making much more malicious programs. The kind which ruin people's lives, and start wars and stuff. No biggie.

It started off small. Simple DDOS hacks, which just lagged the entire server, making it impossible for anyone else to play, while our not-so-beloved hacker racked up kills, by killing immobile, helpless opponents. To the other players on the server, the hacker in question appeared to be teleporting around, or whooshing around the entire map, while they just stared at him, speechless.

As of today, there are many hacks, in various games. First Person Shooters are the worst hit, with Aimbots, Wall hacks, silent aims, spin bots, the list goes on. Even in MOBAs, there are many hacks. Hacks which reduce the cooldowns of certain spells, or eliminate it altogether. Or map hacks, which provide vision of the entire map to our friendly neighbourhood hacker.

opers treated it as a serious problem that needed to be looked into.

To try and limit this cheating epidemic, developers set up many softwares which detected hacks, when anyone used it on a secured server. In Valve games, one of the methods used, to curb cheating is VAC (Valve Anti-Cheat). Games like Team Fortress 2, DOTA 2, Counter Strike: Global Offensive use this to identify, and permanently ban hackers from playing the game on VAC secured servers.

Another popular FPS, Call of Duty, enforced their Anti-Cheat technology under the name "Punkbuster". It does exactly what it says on the cover; busts li'l punks who think they can hack around, and win games, and ruin everybody else's experience.